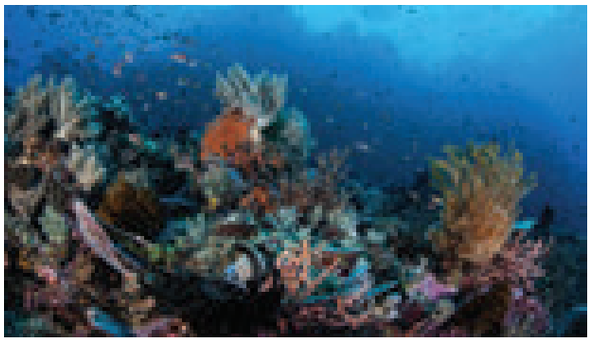
4.5 Marine Resources

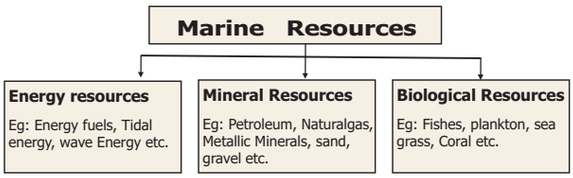
The biotic and abiotic resources found in the oceanic water and at the bottoms are called marine resources. The ocean's resources play a vital role in sustaining the needs of society. A diverse array of marine organisms is used for food, medicine, cosmetics, and a wealth of industrial applications. The world's demand for energy, minerals and water have become increasingly dependent on non-living marine resources.

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- What will happen if the seas and oceans contain only fresh water?



4.5.1 Conservation Of Marine Resources

Oceans are the life blood of planet earth and mankind. The humankind depends on the marine resources for its survival. They are also essential for the economic prosperity, social well-being and quality of life. Oceans have extensive deposits of oil reserves. Besides a major fishing ground, it helps in generating non-conventional energy, development of many ports and harbours for trade activities. Coastal tourism also attracts people around the world, thereby contributing to the economy of many countries.

DISTRIBUTION OF MAJOR OCEAN CURRENTS AND EFFECTS

Ocean	Name of the Current	Effects
South Atlantic Ocean	Benguela Current [Cold]	Leads to foggy conditions along the coast of Namibia. Helped in the development of Namibian & Kalahari deserts
North Atlantic Ocean	Canaries [Cold]	Influences the extension of Sahara Desert
	Gulf Stream [Warm]	Its confluence with the Labrador current produces heavy fog along the coast of Newfoundland, obstacles the navigation. Hence, Newfoundland is one of the major fishing grounds of the world.
	North Atlantic Drift [Warm]	It keeps the ports at higher latitudes ice-free throughout the year. Eg. Port of Rorvik (Norway), Murmansk and Severodvinsk (Russia)
	Labrador [Cold]	Its confluence with Gulf Stream creates fog and hinders navigation.
South Pacific Ocean	Peruvian / Humboldt Current [Cold]	It is one of the causes for the formation of Atacama desert. Change in the nature of Peruvian current, is also associated to the formation of "ELNINO".

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